Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

925 sterling silver, antenna, secure element

Foundation Edition · 10 numbered pieces worldwide

Signet 01 brings the personal seal into digital communication. A touch to a compatible phone signs a message or request, producing a signature that others can verify.

The project

Signet rings have long been used to mark documents and confer authority. Signet 01 carries that idea into a setting where software increasingly prepares and carries out actions on our behalf.

Development began in 2021 with experiments in making an NFC antenna part of an object's form. A secure signing chip turned the object into a key. The ring brings that key together with a deliberate gesture of the hand.

The object

The twelve-turn square spiral is both the ring's mark and its working antenna. It draws power from the phone's NFC field, allowing the electronics to operate without a battery. The ring is cast in sterling silver and finished by hand.

Signing

The phone prepares the request. A secure chip in the ring signs it with a private key held on-chip. The signature can be checked against the request and public key, so changes to the signed content can be detected. What it authorises depends on the receiving system and the permissions granted to the ring.

Specification

Antenna	`12-turn square spiral · 13.56 MHz`
Electronics	`ARX HaLo · passive NFC`
Signing	`ECDSA / secp256k1 · EIP-712 typed data`
Profile	`LUKSO Universal Profile`

A working prototype demonstrates signing. Review and verification software, AI authorisation, blockchain execution, membership and event access are in development.

Provenance

Signet 01 is integrated with LUKSO Universal Profiles. A ring's signing key can be associated with a profile and its permissions updated or revoked. The profile can continue through a change of electronics.

The Register is being developed to record each numbered ring's origin, service history and authorised changes of key.

Servicing

The electronic assembly is designed for replacement, and the silver body can be refinished. A replacement uses a new signing key, to be recorded in the ring's provenance. Service procedures are in development.

Jim Hannon-Tan | Concept and Industrial Design

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer who has worked in Milan, Amsterdam and London and is now based in Adelaide. His work spans everyday objects, medical technology and digital instruments.

Press and allocations

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